

Λυκόφρων ὁ Τραγικός

Lycophron Tragicus and the Alexandrian Pleiad

eul_aid: igg

Period: Ἑλληνιστική [Hellenistic](#)
Dialect: Δράμα Ἀττικόν [Attic Drama](#)
Domain: Ῥητορική [Oratory](#)
Format: Συναγωγή [Collection](#)

Lycophron was a Hellenistic Greek poet and grammarian of the early 3rd century BCE, a native of Chalcis in Euboea. He was a member of the Alexandrian Pleiad, working at the Library of Alexandria under Ptolemy II Philadelphus, where he edited the works of comic poets. Ancient sources record that he was the son of Socles, adopted by the historian Lycus of Rhegium, and that he died from an arrow wound.

Most of Lycophron's works are lost, including his tragedies, a satyr drama, and comedies. His sole surviving work is the **Alexandra**, a notoriously obscure dramatic monologue poem dense with mythological allusion. He is also credited with a scholarly treatise **On Comedy**.

Lycophron exemplifies the Alexandrian scholarly tradition through his editorial work. His enduring significance rests on the **Alexandra**, whose extreme difficulty made it infamous in antiquity and secures his place as a notable, if enigmatic, figure in Hellenistic poetry.

Works (1)

- [Μαρτυρίαι](#) · [Testimonies](#) · 6 passages